

# markpublish Quick Reference

Configuration and Templates

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*Reference for every key of markpublish.yaml and the building blocks of a theme.*

|                  |                     |
|------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Version</b>   | 2.1.7               |
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| <b>Author</b>    | Frank Winter        |
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# markpublish.yaml

Top level: `document`, `theme`, `parts`, optionally `templates_dir`. All paths are relative to the directory of this file. Build with `markpublish build [CONFIG_FILE] [OPTIONS]`.

## Structure

There are exactly two structural tiers. Anything deeper is carried by the Markdown file itself.

```
markpublish.yaml
├─ document:      metadata and global switches
├─ theme:         name of the theme
├─ parts:        list of sections
│   └─ part:      name of the section
│       └─ chapters: list of chapters
│           └─ file: one Markdown file
│               └─ # H1  chapter heading
│               └─ ## H2  structure
│               └─ ### H3  inside the file
```

## document

Metadata and global layout toggles. Only `title` is required.

| Key                    | Default            | Meaning                                                            |
|------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>title</code>     | <i>required</i>    | Document title (cover page, header, filename)                      |
| <code>subtitle</code>  | –                  | Subtitle on the cover page                                         |
| <code>summary</code>   | –                  | Summary / abstract on the cover page                               |
| <code>author</code>    | –                  | Author name                                                        |
| <code>date</code>      | <code>auto</code>  | Date ( <code>auto</code> or <code>today</code> for the build date) |
| <code>version</code>   | –                  | Version on the cover page and in the footer                        |
| <code>status</code>    | –                  | Document status (e.g. <code>Draft</code> , <code>Approved</code> ) |
| <code>copyright</code> | –                  | Copyright notice on the cover page                                 |
| <code>language</code>  | system language    | ISO code for static labels ( <code>de</code> , <code>en</code> )   |
| <code>cover</code>     | <code>false</code> | Generate a cover page                                              |

| Key             | Default              | Meaning                                                  |
|-----------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| header / footer | true                 | Running headers and footers                              |
| document_toc    | full                 | Main table of contents: none, full or a depth            |
| part_toc        | full                 | Default for part divider pages: none, full or a depth    |
| chapter_toc     | full                 | Default for chapter divider pages: none, full or a depth |
| autonum_pattern | see <i>Numbering</i> | How numbers are built; slot 1 is the part here           |
| autonum_reset   | false                | Levels below start again at one when entered             |
| part_label      | from i18n            | Word before a part number (Part); "" drops it            |
| chapter_label   | from i18n            | Word before a chapter number (Chapter); "" drops it      |
| pagenum_reset   | false                | Restart page numbering per part or chapter               |

If the document consists of **exactly one chapter**, the main table of contents omits that chapter's own line: it would merely repeat the cover title, and an entry without siblings distinguishes nothing. The chapter's subheadings stay listed, and its number still appears above the text or on the divider page. `document_toc` still counts structural levels rather than visible lines: for two visible levels (H2 and H3), write `document_toc: 3`.

Custom fields under `document:` (`department: "R&D"`) reach the theme through the `meta` dictionary (`meta.at("department").value`). Static labels belong in `i18n.yaml`, not here.

## parts

A part brackets chapters and passes settings down to them. Without `break_before` it does not show itself.

| Key                | Default         | Meaning                                           |
|--------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| part               | <i>required</i> | Name of the section                               |
| chapters           | <i>required</i> | List of chapters in this section                  |
| toc_title          | part            | Title in the main table of contents               |
| divider_title      | part            | Title on the divider page                         |
| subtitle / summary | –               | Subtitle and summary on the divider page          |
| break_before       | none            | divider, page or none                             |
| document_toc       | inherited       | Contribution to the main TOC; none hides the part |
| part_toc           | inherited       | Local TOC on its own divider page                 |

| Key                          | Default   | Meaning                                                   |
|------------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>chapter_toc</code>     | inherited | Default for the divider pages of its chapters             |
| <code>autonum_pattern</code> | inherited | Numbers of its chapters; slot 1 is the chapter here       |
| <code>autonum_reset</code>   | inherited | Chapters of this part start again at one                  |
| <code>label</code>           | from i18n | Word before its own number                                |
| <code>chapter_label</code>   | inherited | Word before the number of each of its chapters (Appendix) |
| <code>pagenum_reset</code>   | inherited | Restart page numbering at the start of the part           |

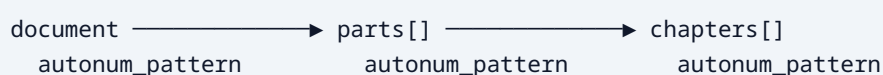
## chapters

A chapter is one Markdown file. Its name comes from that file's # heading.

| Key                             | Default         | Meaning                                                                   |
|---------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>file</code>               | <i>required</i> | Path to the Markdown file                                                 |
| <code>show_title</code>         | true            | Show the file's H1 on the content page                                    |
| <code>toc_title</code>          | file H1         | Title in the table of contents and running header                         |
| <code>divider_title</code>      | file H1         | Title on the divider page                                                 |
| <code>subtitle / summary</code> | –               | Subtitle and summary on the divider page                                  |
| <code>break_before</code>       | page            | divider, page OR none                                                     |
| <code>document_toc</code>       | inherited       | Contribution to the main TOC ( <i>none</i> , <i>full</i> , <i>depth</i> ) |
| <code>chapter_toc</code>        | inherited       | Local TOC on its own divider page                                         |
| <code>autonum_pattern</code>    | inherited       | Numbers <i>inside</i> the chapter; slot 1 is the H2 here                  |
| <code>autonum_reset</code>      | inherited       | Headings of this chapter start again at one                               |
| <code>label</code>              | inherited       | Word before its own number (Appendix A: ...)                              |
| <code>pagenum_reset</code>      | inherited       | Restart page numbering at the start of the chapter                        |

## Inheritance

Everything marked *inherited* flows from the outside in; the innermost setting wins.



|               |               |               |
|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| autonum_reset | autonum_reset | autonum_reset |
| document_toc  | document_toc  | document_toc  |
| part_toc      | part_toc      | -             |
| chapter_toc   | chapter_toc   | chapter_toc   |
| pagenum_reset | pagenum_reset | pagenum_reset |
| part_label    | label         | -             |
| chapter_label | chapter_label | label         |

## Numbering

A pattern describes the levels *below* the place it stands — so slot 1 shifts with that place.

| Level        | under document | on a part | on a chapter |
|--------------|----------------|-----------|--------------|
| Part         | slot 1         | -         | -            |
| Chapter (H1) | slot 2         | slot 1    | -            |
| H2           | slot 3         | slot 2    | slot 1       |
| H3           | slot 4         | slot 3    | slot 2       |
| ⋮            | ⋮              | ⋮         | ⋮            |
| H6           | slot 7         | slot 6    | slot 5       |

**Symbols:** 1 → 1, 2, 3 · 01 → 01, 02 · a / A → a, b / A, B · i / I → i, ii / I, II · \_ level without a number · + repeats the slot before it for every deeper level. Slots are separated by |; everything else in a slot is a literal, reserved characters go in single quotes ('Article '1').

|             |                        |                                     |
|-------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| on document | "_ 1 .1 +"             | part unnumbered · chapter 1 · 1.1   |
| on document | "_ _ 1 .1 +"           | single-chapter document: H2 becomes |
| 1., 2., 3.  |                        |                                     |
| on document | "I 1 .1 +"             | Part I · chapters 1, 2, 3 through   |
| on a part   | "A .1 +"               | chapter A · A.1 · A.1.1             |
| on a part   | "'Article '1 ' ('1')'" | Article 1 · Article 1 (2)           |

Without a setting, "\_|1|.1|+" applies: parts unnumbered, chapters 1, 1.1, 1.1.1.

The part number does **not** enter the chapter numbers; a part with document\_toc: "none" gets none and consumes none. A notated label steps in front of the heading's number (Appendix A: Schema) without reaching the subheadings (A.1).

# Templates and Themes

Everything visible is controlled by a theme: typography, page layout, and static text. The built-in default theme `default` is provided for PDF.

## Where Themes Are Located

The first match wins — a theme is always loaded from exactly one source location and never merged across multiple locations. Which theme is used is determined by the `--theme` command-line option or the `theme:` setting in `markpublish.yaml` (default: `default`).

| Rank       | Location                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. User    | <code>~/.markpublish/templates/&lt;theme&gt;/</code> or user-specific AppData directory                                                                       |
| 2. Project | <code>--templates-dir</code> on CLI, <code>templates_dir:</code> in YAML, <code>MARKPUBLISH_TEMPLATES_DIR</code> , or <code>./templates/&lt;theme&gt;/</code> |
| 3. Package | Built-in standard theme <code>default</code>                                                                                                                  |

`markpublish templates` lists all templates available on the system along with their resolution rank and origin.

## Customizing a Theme

```
markpublish export-template default ./templates
```

This command copies the built-in theme files into your project directory, where resolution rank 2 automatically discovers and uses them on the next build. For PDF output, a theme directory contains:

- `template.typ`: Main Typst layout template defining page geometry, headers, footers, and styles
- `i18n.yaml`: Shared label definitions and localized strings across the theme
- `pdf/i18n.yaml`: Format-specific label definitions and string overrides for PDF
- `fonts/`: Optional custom font files (.ttf, .otf) loaded by Typst
- `assets/`: Image assets, logos, and vector icons

## Static Labels (i18n)

Labels resolve through a four-stage cascade; a lower level overrides only the keys it explicitly defines:

| Level            | File                                                |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Application   | markpublish/i18n.yaml (application default strings) |
| 2. Theme         | <templates>/<theme>/i18n.yaml                       |
| 3. Target format | <templates>/<theme>/pdf/i18n.yaml                   |
| 4. Project       | ./i18n.yaml next to markpublish.yaml                |

Each file is organized by language code (de:, en:); the key "\*" applies to all languages. Level 4 belongs to the project: it allows overriding labels and localizing custom metadata fields (department: "Department"). Use markpublish labels --overridden or markpublish labels --theme <theme> to inspect the cascade before building.

## Key CLI Commands

| Command                     | Key Options                                      | Description                             |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| markpublish build           | --theme, --target, -o, --templates-dir           | Compile document to PDF                 |
| markpublish init            | [TARGET], --title, --lang                        | Set up a minimal starter project        |
| markpublish cheatsheet      | --lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir             | Generate this quick reference as PDF    |
| markpublish manual          | --lang, --theme, -o, --templates-dir             | Generate the complete user manual       |
| markpublish templates       | --target, --templates-dir                        | List templates and lookup rank          |
| markpublish export-template | [THEME], [TARGET], --target                      | Export template files for customization |
| markpublish labels          | --theme, --target, --templates-dir, --overridden | Inspect static labels and metadata      |